

Security

A substantial amount of energy and resources is being spent on educating employees that there is no leakage of private information in confirming their identity through Aadhaar. When an individual authenticates his identity using the Aadhaar-linked biometric system, the vendor is not provided with any information. Only the fingerprint proof is validated for the entered Aadhaar number by matching it with the one stored in the Aadhaar server. It is only one-way communication.

Daman Singh, managing director of MindTech Solutions, adds, "Government buildings are looking to install multiple systems at their every entry gate. Kits are being retailed at 60,000 to 70,000 rupees per unit to organisations, generating up to 40 per cent profit for the vendor."

The investment required

"The business investment isn't a major concern, it is about getting your system approved and registered with UIDAI for AEBAS usage by the government body. Once that is taken care of, one may begin with an initial investment of approximately three million rupees. However, the investment cost varies depending on a lot of factors like the quality of product, the inventory to be maintained, whether the land infrastructure is owned or rented, etc," adds Daman. "I personally feel that vendors who have an experience in dealing with biometric attendance systems will definitely have an edge."

There are various devices that support AEBAS, and different organisations are choosing to install different systems ranging from desktops to laptops.

Adaptation elements

"Government organisations and employees need to register themselves on attendance.gov.in. This is an online platform created by central government whereby we can see real-time attendance data of government bodies. Once they have registered, they just need to install any biometric device of their choice and provide con-

nectivity either through Wi-Fi, LAN, PoE (power over ethernet) or mobile broadband. These devices can then communicate with the central server, that is AEBAS. So the process is simple yet efficient," shares Het Vaghela of Matrix.

Road ahead

Government organisations with over 210 million employees offer immense growth potential. At the same time, solution providers are optimistic about use of AEBAS in private organisations as well. The initiative is drawing encouragement from various stakeholders as it is a part of Digital India initiative. **EFY**

—Nidhi Arora, executive editor, EFY

Streetlighting: Should States Invest In Solar?

➤ In areas where cabling and grid power maintenance might be a challenge, investing in solar streetlights is a good option

The call for energy-efficiency has been stronger than ever, and states like Delhi are steer-

ing the drive right from the streets. AC mains-driven LED streetlights are great as low-cost power savers. On the other hand, those who intend to move away from drawing grid power altogether, should consider investing in solar LED streetlights. There are options to ensure optimal returns from streetlighting setups, some of which we explore here.

AC mains-driven LED streetlights: Quick returns

The initial investment in LED technology is higher but it guarantees at least 50 per cent more energy savings than conventional fluorescent lights that dominated the market until recently.

A single LED streetlight setup costs between ₹ 2000 and ₹ 5000 depending on a number of factors, including the LED lumen output, wattage, component quality and cabling. Luminaires of the LED setup generally cost ₹ 30-40 per watt, so power requirements of the user play a major role in determining the end product's cost. For example, while a 12W system may cost around ₹ 850, a 40W luminaire can cost up to ₹ 2500. Additional expenses include cables for AC mains connection, pole for installing the luminaire and installation charges. If the luminaire can be mounted on a wall, there is no need for the pole.

In areas with stable power availability, state governments can expect a quick return on their investment in AC mains-driven streetlights. An executive from Electropower, a Faridabad-based LED streetlight



Solar LED streetlights